How to Create a Professional One-Page CV

This is a **learning guide**, not just a template. Take your time reading it from top to bottom. By the end, you will understand exactly **what a CV is, why it matters, and how to build your own step by step.**

This guide is for **beginners** — even if you are **not good with computers**, don't worry! Follow the steps one by one, and by the end, you will have a **clean, professional CV** ready to send to employers.

What Is a CV?

A **CV (Curriculum Vitae)** is a **one-page document** that tells an employer:

- **Who you are**
- **How to contact you**
- **What experience or skills you have**

It's like your **personal advertisement** — it shows why **you should be chosen** for a job.

The Structure of a Perfect One-Page CV

Your CV must follow this order:

1. **Your Full Name** (big and bold at the top)
2. **Professional Photo** (clear headshot, plain background)
3. **Contact Details**
    - Phone number
    - Email address (professional — e.g. *name.surname@gmail.com*)
    - City & Country (no full address needed)

4. **Short Summary (2–3 lines)**
    - Example: *Hardworking cashier with 2 years of experience. Friendly, reliable, and fast at customer service.*
5. **Work Experience** (Most recent first)
    - Job Title — Company (Dates)
    - 2–3 bullet points explaining what you did
6. **Education / Qualifications**
7. **Skills** (List as bullet points)
8. **References** — "Available on request" OR add a supervisor's name + phone

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📸 How to Take a Good CV Photo

- Plain background (wall or curtain)
- Face clearly visible (no hat, no sunglasses)
- Smart clothing (even a clean T-shirt is fine)
- Head and shoulders only
- No filters or heavy edits

What Is ATS — and Why It Matters

ATS = Applicant Tracking System.
It's a **computer that reads CVs before a human does.**

If your CV is too *fancy*, uses *tables* or *strange fonts*, the computer **might not read it — and your CV will be rejected automatically.**

To be **ATS-Friendly**, follow these rules:

- Use **simple fonts**: Arial, Calibri, Times New Roman
- **No tables or text boxes**
- **No graphics or decorations**

- Use **simple bullet points** (•)
- Save your CV as **PDF** before sending

CV Template You Can Copy

[YOUR FULL NAME]

Phone: [your number] | Email: [your.email@example.com] | City, Country

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY
Short 2-line sentence about your experience and strengths.

WORK EXPERIENCE
Job Title — Company Name (Month Year – Month Year)
• Bullet point of what you did
• Bullet point of your main task or achievement

EDUCATION
School or Training — Qualification — Year

SKILLS
• Skill 1
• Skill 2
• Skill 3

REFERENCES
Available on request

Common CV Mistakes to Avoid

Wrong	Right
Too long (2+ pages)	One page only
Fancy colours & borders	Simple, clean layout
Emoji / slang	Professional tone
Full home address	Only city & country
"WhatsApp Queen 1999" email	Use real name email

Final Checklist Before Sending

✔ One page only
✔ Clear photo
✔ Correct spelling
✔ Saved as PDF
✔ Easy to read simple layout
✔ Contact details correct